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The Woodlands to boost law enforcement with 30 new Flock Safety cameras around the community

By **Catherine Dominguez**, *Staff Writer*

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The Woodlands is adding 30 Flock Safety cameras, seen in this file photo, to the community, with law enforcement planning to have them installed by summer.

Submitted Flock Safety

The Woodlands is adding 30 Flock Safety cameras to the community, with law enforcement planning to have them installed by summer.

The purchase, approved as part of the township's 2026 budget, will require \$109,500 the first year, with an annual cost of \$90,000. The cameras will be placed "strategically" in and around The Woodlands, officials said.

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“The Flock cameras are an incredible force multiplier,” Montgomery County Sheriff’s Office Chief Deputy Jonathan Zitzmann said during the township Dec. 4 meeting. “It provides law enforcement with incredible investigative leads to solve crime.”

Zitzmann said the cameras also deter criminal activity.



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The sheriff’s office is working to install the cameras before summer, when “quality of life crimes,” such as vandalism and panhandling, increase.

Flock Safety is a public safety operating system that uses license plate reading cameras to provide 24/7 monitoring for police departments, homes, businesses and neighborhoods.

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While Township Chairman Brad Bailey said the board hasn't had any negative feedback about the cameras, the system does have some opposition.

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The American Civil Liberties Union of Texas has raised privacy concerns related to the cameras.

The organization believes the extensive network of surveillance cameras enables it to determine where people are in the city, where they are going, and who they are seeing, according to a previous Chronicle article.

However, Flock Safety officials said that customers, such as the Montgomery County Sheriff's Office, own the data collected and have exclusive access to it. According to the company, every evidence search in the system is logged and requires a search reason. After 30 days, if that data is not used, it is permanently deleted.

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Catherine Dominguez is a Houston Chronicle reporter who covers Montgomery County, including the city of Conroe and Conroe ISD.

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